

In the last week I finally feel like I am getting my head back on straight for the first time since Christmas.

I'm not sure what the fix was but I imagine that each of these help

• Finn

• Exercising marginally more often

• End in sight for this metatheory project

• Voicing my emotional exhaustion and externally lamenting a lack of innocence / familial safety blanket

• Engaging in hobbies like being a vike coding king

In any case, it's been nice.

I also think that I've been understanding more the ways in which I was a horrible partner to Maria while we were together.

The effects of my inattentiveness really put a strain on not only a relationship romantically, but also in a partnership.

Even after the romantic ship had sailed, I was dead weight as a caretaker to Olive.

Maybe Finn's presence has me realizing the weight of caring for a funny little creature, and I'm realizing that I wasn't much of a parent to Olive. I was a burden to be managed. I was a scared snittles child w/ a Golden Retriever as a best friend, not a level-headed adult who was equipped to care for her — or to viscerally understand the weight of a marriage for that matter.

I understand even more now how unequipped I really was for the whole situation, and I empathize a lot more w/ Maria the more I reflect on things.

I don't think she's evil by any means.

Anything comparable to having my partner lose their mother, who I loved as well, at such a young age, or having my sister-in-law inflicting her undiagnosed personality disorder on my environment; either of these would surely drive me crazy. Probably even crazier than Maria was, much that she was crazy at all.

In retrospect, I think she was doing what she could. Perhaps that wasn't enough and never could be, and maybe that's okay.

My lizard brain wants so badly to sort things into us v. them, hero v. villain, etc.

I don't see how that can really apply here.

I tried to hate her, and I ended not w/ disdain but with apathy. I came away w/ a deep-seated belief that I can not live a full life w/ her as my wife.

This was known to me after being married, and it is probably why my eyes strayed so easily.

So if she isn't the villain, my instincts say that it must be me. I've put a lot of work into trying to forgive myself and give grace for the confounding emotional nightmare of losing Thom.

Some days I even believe that I am not evil for what has transpired in my love life.

I don't even know what I'm on about anymore. I think I want to say genuinely to Maria that I'm sorry and that I am very grateful for the time together in our lives. I am sure that it doesn't look like that externally, but I do truly mean it. I don't know precisely when, but one day a switch flipped and our love became obligation and duty, not joy, passion, or desire. I think some couples can make that work, but they shouldn't have to. Especially when so young and wrapped up in grief.

Being in this dutiful arrangement I knew was unhealthy and unsustainable, and I didn't know how to de-escalate or fix it. There's no return from marriage that isn't a damaging divorce. There was no real solution. We could've learned to love each other again, but that's not any way to begin your life-long marriage. That's a tool for the old folks, for those saddled w/ kids.

I knew that the only real path forward was a breakup and I couldn't admit it to myself or to you. I couldn't own my emotions enough. I couldn't be kind enough to give you a moment of cruelty and honesty. Instead I drove you to look into my journal and stumble upon the unholy truth for yourself, and for that I am so deeply regretful. I owed that to you.

As my wife, as my friend and partner, I owed you the truth.

Rachel defended today and her and Preet did the "doctor" and Doctor routine. It made me think of you.

As much as I don't want to be your husband, I do wish I could be your friend in some capacity, but, I don't think that's how these things work.

If for nothing else, I wish I could've seen you finish med school. You sacrificed so much to succeed there. Some may even say you sacrificed our relationship.

In a paradoxical way that makes me wish that I could've seen that it was worth it in some sense. Maybe that's a fucked way to view things and I don't really believe it. I talk

That's all to say, I'm sorry then. I sincerely hope you're doing well and find happiness, whatever that looks like for you. And it almost certainly doesn't look like what you thought it did when you were 18. Please listen to what you are actually feeling and adjust accordingly. Despite the loss and turmoil getting here, that's what I've tried to do and I think it's worth it. I feel like I am living as earnestly as I can.

I am trying to trust my gut, as it knows things that I don't. If there were any lesson in this world to learn from our time together it is that the gut can't be ignored. It'll come back around one way or another.

I really ought to start journaling regularly again.